

1. DEFENCE & NAVAL AFFAIRS

INS Nirdeshak visits Cambodia

- INS Nirdeshak, a survey vessel of the **Eastern Naval Command**, is on a goodwill visit to Cambodia.
- Commissioned in **2001**; built jointly by **Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (Kolkata)** and **Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders (Mumbai)**.
- Belongs to the **Kora-class** of survey ships.
- Visited the **Ream Naval Base** in Cambodia to strengthen friendly bilateral relations.
- Deployed under India's **Project Mahasagar**.
- India–Cambodia also conduct a joint naval exercise referred to in class as the **Sindex Exercise**.

Cambodia — Quick Facts

- Region: South-East Asia | Capital: **Phnom Penh** | Currency: **Riel** | Historic dynasty/heritage: **Khmer**.

2. NDA / CDS EXAM QUESTIONS

Q1. Theme of Indian Army Day for the year 2026

Answer: **Networking and Data** (the 2025 theme had focused on Reforms in the Defence field).

Q2. Writ meaning 'You have the Body'

There are five types of writs; the fifth is **Quo Warranto**. The writ meaning 'to have the body' is **Habeas Corpus**.

3. SEMICON INDIA 2026 SUMMIT

- Venue: **New Delhi** (Yashobhoomi, Dwarka) — held from **17–19 September 2026**.
- This is the **5th edition** of Semicon India; conducted under the **Ministry of Electronics & IT**.
- Theme 2026: **'From Silicon to System'**.
- Theme 2025 (also held in Delhi): **'Building the Next Semiconductor Powerhouse'**.
- Semicon India 2024 was held in **Noida**.
- **~40 countries** and **40 startups** participating.
- Semiconductors first discussed by India around **2007**; India's Semiconductor Policy came in **2021**.
- First Indian state with its own semiconductor policy: **Gujarat** — Gujarat is also set to host India's semiconductor hub.
- World's semiconductor hub: **South Korea**.
- India's own indigenous chip is named **'Vikram'**.
- Union Budget 2026 launched the next phase — **'Semicon 2.0'**.

4. JEWISH NEW YEAR — ROSH HASHANAH

- PM Modi greeted the Jewish community on their New Year, wishing PM **Benjamin Netanyahu** of **Israel**.
- Israel is the world's only Jewish nation; formed in **1948**.
- Israel's Parliament is called the **Knesset**.
- The festival is celebrated in the Hebrew month of **Tishrei** (falls between September–October as per the Hebrew calendar).
- Hebrew is the official language of Israel.
- Key traditions: apples dipped in **honey**; a musical (ram's horn) instrument called the **Shofar** is blown; prayers read from a special prayer book called the **Machzor**; a special bread called **Challah** is served.
- Rosh Hashanah is sometimes referred to as a 'Light Festival' — do not confuse this with Diwali in exam questions.
- PM Modi has earlier been conferred an honour/award by Israel.

5. GST — EXAM QUESTION

Statement 1: Levy & collection of GST on inter-State trade is covered under **Article 269A** of the Constitution — Correct.

Statement 2: GST on inter-State trade is **not** levied/collected directly by the State — Correct.

Statement 3: GST revenue is apportioned between the Union and the States — Correct.

Answer: **All of the above are correct.**

- GST is regulated by the **GST Council**, chaired by Finance Minister **Nirmala Sitharaman**.
- GST is an **Indirect Tax**.
- Current GST slabs: **5%, 18%** and a special **40%** slab for items like tobacco and luxury goods.

6. ARCHERY — WORLD CUP FINAL

- **Dhiraj Bommadevara** became the **first Indian male** archer to win a **Gold Medal** at the Archery World Cup Final.
- Venue: **Tlaxcala, Mexico**.
- He defeated the player from **Japan** in the final.
- India won a total of **7 medals**, including **4 Gold medals**, at this event.
- Para-Archery: **Sheetal Devi** also won Gold here; she had earlier won a **Bronze medal** at the Olympics.
- Archery is the national sport of **Bhutan**.
- (Recall: India's first individual Olympic Gold medallist was **Abhinav Bindra** — shooting, Beijing 2008.)

7. STATE ELECTION COMMISSION — EXAM QUESTION

Statement 1: Elections to the Panchayats take place under the direction of the State Election Commission — Correct.

Statement 2: The SEC is appointed by the Governor on the advice of the Chief Election Commissioner — **Incorrect** (no such advice is required).

Answer: **Only Statement 1 is correct.**

8. STEEL SLAG ROAD — CHHATTISGARH

- Chhattisgarh built the **world's longest Steel Slag Road**, a record-setting stretch of **1.85 km** (4-lane), in **Raigarh**.
- Built by **Jindal Steel** in partnership with **CSIR**.
- India's earlier (first) slag road (2024) was built near **Hazira Port, Surat, Gujarat**.
- Steel slag = processed industrial waste from steel/iron plants, made by **smelting Iron Ore** in the presence of oxygen (oxygen furnace).
- Slag contains **magnesium, ammonia, aluminium and calcium**.
- Such roads are **eco-friendly** and cut construction cost by about **40%**.

9. MEKONG-GANGA COOPERATION

- Member countries: **India, Cambodia, Laos, Myanmar, Thailand and Vietnam** (Answer option A in the exam question — note Bangladesh is NOT a member).
- The Mekong River originates in **China** and drains into the **Gulf of Thailand**.
- India is developing this initiative as the **Mekong-Ganga Corridor**.

10. UPPER BHADRA PROJECT — KARNATAKA

- After **50 years**, water finally reached a part of Karnataka via the Upper Bhadra Project.
- The Krishna river (originates at the Mahabaleshwar plateau, Maharashtra) has tributaries **Tunga** and **Bhadra**, which together form the **Tungabhadra** river (flows past Hampi).
- Tungabhadra river itself originates from the **Varaha Hills, Karnataka**.
- 'Upper' Bhadra Project = water lifted from a lower reservoir to a higher one, routed via **Chitradurga** to the **Gonur Lake**.
- Developed and funded (■**150 crore**) entirely by the **Central Government** (not the State); given the status of a **National Project**.
- Relevant constitutional provision: **Article 262** — resolution of inter-State river/lake water disputes.
- On the Krishna river sits the **Almatti Dam**.

11. BIOSPHERE RESERVE — STATE MATCH

Match the Biosphere Reserve with its State:

- Srisaillam (Nagarjunasagar-Srisaillam)** — Andhra Pradesh / Telangana
- Manas** — Assam
- Similipal** — Odisha
- Panna** — Madhya Pradesh

Answer: **All pairs correctly matched** (straightforward match-the-following).

12. COLOMBO SECURITY CONCLAVE

- A tabletop naval exercise was conducted by the **Eastern Naval Command** at **Visakhapatnam** (Andhra Pradesh, Bay of Bengal).
- Announced by Foreign Secretary **Vikram Misri**.
- Participating countries: **India, Sri Lanka, Maldives, Mauritius and Bangladesh**.
- Aim: maritime security in the **Indian Ocean** — curbing smuggling, piracy and other illegal activity, ensuring water safety.
- Separately, the **Quad** (India, USA, Japan, Australia) also held its own tabletop exercise in **Tokyo**.

13. RAMSAR SITE — EXAM QUESTION

Statement 1: India has the highest number of Ramsar Sites in Asia — Correct.

Statement 2: Patna Bird Sanctuary (a Ramsar Site) is located in Etah district, Uttar Pradesh — Correct.

Answer: **Both statements are correct.**

14. GALAXEYE — BENGALURU STARTUP

- **GalaxEye**, a Bengaluru-based space-tech startup, has been granted a **US Patent** — the first such Indian startup to receive one, giving its technology global recognition.
- In **May 2026**, GalaxEye launched a satellite mission called '**Mission Drishti**' in partnership with **SpaceX**.
- The satellite project itself is named '**Optosar**'.
- Future plan: launch **30 satellites** over the next **5 years**.
- Current funding raised: about **US \$21 million**.

15. HINDI DIWAS & OFFICIAL LANGUAGE CONFERENCE

- **Hindi Diwas** was observed on **14 September**; Hindi was given the status of Official Language in **1949**.
- Devanagari is recognised as the script of the official language.
- Key Articles: **343** (Hindi as the Official Language), **344** (President may constitute a Commission/Committee), **350** (redressal of language-related grievances), **350A** (instruction in mother tongue), **351** (promotion/development of the Hindi language).
- Administered under the **Ministry of Home Affairs**; Hindi Diwas was first celebrated in **1953**.
- The **All India Official Language Conference** began in **2021**, first held in **Varanasi**.
- This year's edition (2026) is the **6th edition**, held in **Mumbai** and addressed/headed by Home Minister **Amit Shah**.
- **World Hindi Day** is observed separately on **10 January**, marking the first World Hindi Conference held in **Nagpur in 1975** under PM Indira Gandhi. This year's World Hindi Conference (2 days) was also held in Mumbai.

16. WOMEN'S ASIA CUP CRICKET 2026

- **India** won the Women's Asia Cup Final by **72 runs**, defeating **Sri Lanka**.
- Tournament final held in **Dubai, UAE**; final concluded on **13 September**.
- First edition of the tournament was held in **2004 in Sri Lanka** — India won that edition too.
- Opening partnership of **Shafali Verma** and **Smriti Mandhana** added **~129 runs** — the highest opening stand in Women's Asia Cup history.
- India has now won the title a total of **8 times**; last won it in **2022** (tournament held every 2 years).
- Organised by the **Asian Cricket Council**, headed by **Mohsin Naqvi** (Pakistan).
- India's team once again **declined to collect the trophy** from the ACC chief, as with the Men's Asia Cup earlier.
- Captain of the Indian women's team: **Harmanpreet Kaur**.
- Next **Men's Asia Cup (2027)** is scheduled to be hosted by **Bangladesh**.

17. QUICK REVISION — MORE HEADLINES

- PM Modi held his **24th Summit** with Russian President **Vladimir Putin**.
- BRICS Summit leadership for **2027** goes to **China**.
- **Rameshwaram Temple** was showcased/featured at the BRICS Summit.
- **Southern Railway** zone has become **100% electrified**.
- **China Southern Airlines** is starting a new route between **Guangzhou and Delhi**.
- **79th session** of the WHO Regional Committee meeting was held, resulting in the **Delhi Declaration**.
- A new fish species — informally noted as '**Schistura gopsi**' in class — was discovered in **Arunachal Pradesh**.
- The Yemeni port of **Mokha** was captured by the **Houthis**.
- US Open tennis title was discussed in class, with the winner defeating **Aryna Sabalenka** in the final.
- **Saragarhi Diwas** observed on **12 September**, commemorating the **Battle of Saragarhi (1897)**, depicted in the film *Kesari*.

MCQ COMPILATION — ALL QUESTIONS ASKED IN CLASS**Q1. What is the theme of Indian Army Day for the year 2026?**

- (A) Reforms in Defence
- (B) Networking and Data
- (C) Atmanirbhar Defence
- (D) Digital Warfare

Ans: (B) Networking and Data**Q2. In which city will Semicon India 2026 be held (17–19 September)?**

- (A) Mumbai
- (B) Noida
- (C) Delhi
- (D) Hyderabad

Ans: (C) Delhi**Q3. Which writ literally means 'You have the Body'?**

- (A) Mandamus
- (B) Certiorari
- (C) Quo Warranto
- (D) Habeas Corpus

Ans: (D) Habeas Corpus**Q4. PM Modi greeted which country's people on their Jewish New Year festival (also called a 'Light Festival')?**

- (A) USA
- (B) Israel
- (C) Jordan
- (D) Egypt

Ans: (B) Israel — festival is Rosh Hashanah, PM: Benjamin Netanyahu**Q5 (GST). Which of the following statements is/are correct?**

1. Levy and collection of GST on inter-State trade & commerce is provided under Article 269A.
 2. Such GST is not levied and collected by the State.
 3. GST revenue is apportioned between the Union and the States.
- (A) 1 and 2 only
 - (B) 2 and 3 only
 - (C) 1 and 3 only
 - (D) All of the above

Ans: (D) All of the above are correct**Q6. Who became the first Indian male archer to win Gold at the Archery World Cup Final?**

- (A) Abhinav Bindra
- (B) Dhiraj Bommadevara
- (C) Atanu Das
- (D) Tarundeep Rai

Ans: (B) Dhiraj Bommadevara (defeated Japan; event held in Tlaxcala, Mexico)**Q7 (State Election Commission). Which statement is correct?**

1. Elections to the Panchayats take place under the direction of the State Election Commission.
 2. The SEC is appointed by the Governor on the advice of the Chief Election Commissioner.
- (A) Only 1
 - (B) Only 2
 - (C) Both 1 and 2
 - (D) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans: (A) Only Statement 1 is correct**Q8. Which Indian state built the world's longest Steel Slag Road?**

- (A) Gujarat
- (B) Odisha
- (C) Chhattisgarh
- (D) Jharkhand

Ans: (C) Chhattisgarh (Raigarh, 1.85 km, by Jindal Steel with CSIR)**Q9. Which group of countries are members of the Mekong–Ganga Cooperation?**

- (A) India, Cambodia, Laos, Myanmar, Thailand, Vietnam
- (B) India, Bangladesh, Laos, Myanmar, Thailand, Vietnam
- (C) India, China, Laos, Myanmar, Thailand, Vietnam
- (D) India, Cambodia, Bangladesh, Myanmar, Thailand, Vietnam

Ans: (A)**Q10. After the Upper Bhadra Project, water reached a particular area after 50 years — in which state?**

- (A) Andhra Pradesh
- (B) Karnataka
- (C) Telangana
- (D) Maharashtra

Ans: (B) Karnataka**Q11. Match the Biosphere Reserves with their States: Srisailem, Manas, Simlipal, Panna.**

- (A) AP/Telangana, Assam, Odisha, MP — all correctly matched
- (B) Odisha, Assam, MP, AP — mismatched
- (C) MP, Odisha, Assam, AP — mismatched
- (D) None matched correctly

Ans: (A) All pairs correctly matched**Q12. The Colombo Security Conclave tabletop exercise was conducted by which naval command?**

- (A) Western Naval Command
- (B) Southern Naval Command
- (C) Eastern Naval Command
- (D) Andaman & Nicobar Command

Ans: (C) Eastern Naval Command, Visakhapatnam**Q13 (Ramsar Sites). Which statement(s) is/are correct?**

1. India has the highest number of Ramsar Sites in Asia.
 2. Patna Bird Sanctuary (a Ramsar Site) is located in Etah district, Uttar Pradesh.
- (A) Only 1
 - (B) Only 2
 - (C) Both 1 and 2
 - (D) Neither

Ans: (C) Both statements are correct**Q14. Which Bengaluru-based startup was recently granted a US Patent for its space technology?**

- (A) Skyroot Aerospace
- (B) Agnikul Cosmos
- (C) GalaxEye
- (D) Pixxel

Ans: (C) GalaxEye**Q15. Who won the Women's Asia Cup 2026 final, defeating Sri Lanka by 72 runs?**

- (A) Bangladesh
- (B) Pakistan
- (C) India
- (D) Australia

Ans: (C) India (captain: Harmanpreet Kaur; final held in Dubai, UAE)